



REPUBLIC OF ZAMBIA

**LUFWANYAMA TOWN COUNCIL CITIZEN ENGAGEMENT
STRATEGY - 2024**

With a Focus on Output Based Budgeting and Project Implementation Management

1. Introduction

Stakeholder engagement is key to developing and implementing programs, and projects which are responsive to the needs of the community. Lufwanyama Town Council has developed this Citizen Engagement Strategy to enable an effective platform for productive interaction between the Local Authority and its stakeholders. This document will guide and inform various stakeholders within and outside the District on the means of engagement in identifying and implementing development programs and projects in the District. This tool will also serve as a guide in bringing stakeholders on board during the budgeting process.

1.1 Background

Lufwanyama Town Council recognizes the importance of Stakeholder Engagement in promoting inclusive development and good governance. Stakeholder engagement provides a platform for stakeholders to participate in the development process. This includes identifying development needs, and interventions to address such. Thus, helping to design and implement programs and projects which are relevant to the communities in Lufwanyama. Stakeholder engagement also enhances interaction between the Local Authority and the community thereby promoting transparency and accountability in the utilization of public resources.

Additionally, stakeholder engagement is crucial in identifying the environmental, health, and social risks which may be associated with proposed development interventions. Therefore, it helps to mitigate risks and conflicts, and also improves project outcomes.

The development of this tool is also a fulfilment of Article 205(d) of the Constitution of Zambia which provides for public participation in the budget process; as well as the Access to Information Act No. 8 of 2024 which gives citizens, media, and civil society the right to access information by public

authorities; and the National Decentralization Policy whose theme is '*Realizing Local Development through Citizen Participation.*'"

Thus, it must be emphasized that the development of this plan is a means to achieve goals to empower the citizens, improve decision-making and foster trust between the Local Authority and its stakeholders.

1.2 Current Stakeholder Engagement Efforts by Lufwanyama

Town Council

Over the years, the Local Authority has utilized various means to bring stakeholders on board in shaping the development agenda of the District. Engagement meetings have been held with traditional and religious leaders, Government departments, community-based organizations, sub-district structures such as the Ward Development Committees, Community Welfare Assistance Committees, and Satellite Disaster Management Committees and the communities at large for issues pertaining to the development of the District.

Most of these meetings have been centered on raising awareness about government driven programs such as the Constituency Development Fund (CDF), Cash for Work, Community Sport, and enhancing the Local Authority's revenue mobilization and other programs within the Local Authority. Some stakeholders were also engaged during the formulation process of the Integrated Development Plan. The challenge with some of the previous engagements have been due poor attendance, hence compromising community representation.

The development of this Citizen Engagement Strategy will endeavor to address some of the challenges the Local Authority has been facing in actualizing meaningful stakeholder engagement. This plan has categorized stakeholders to be engaged in different development interventions and the means and timelines of engagement have been outlined. The plan has also taken a more inclusive approach to bring on board marginal groups in the District such as the people living with disabilities, women, and the youth. The plan has

provided means of sharing information with the residents of Lufwanyama on the updates and decisions over the budget and project cycle processes.

2 Vision, Aim, and Objectives

This section highlights the Vision, Aim and objectives of the Citizen Engagement Strategy

2.1 Vision

To be a model Municipal Council in the provision of sustainable and quality services in Zambia by 2030.

2.2 Aim

- To effectively engage stakeholders, foster partnerships, and ensure their active participation in decision – making processes, ultimately contributing to the success and sustainability of the development interventions

2.3 Objectives

- Enhance stakeholder participation in project identification and prioritization of development interventions.
- Increase citizen involvement in budgetary and project decision-making processes.
- Improve transparency and accountability in budget and project implementation through citizen engagement,
- Strengthen public monitoring of budget and project execution.
- Proactively address stakeholder concerns and issues

2. Approaches and Methods of Engagement

The Local Authority will use different initiatives to foster inclusive participation, acknowledging the varied backgrounds of the residents. Efforts will also concentrate on promoting a balanced exchange between

citizens and civic leaders, steering clear of a biased approach. Given that citizen engagement is an ongoing endeavor, the Local Authority will employ various channels and approaches to communicate effectively with all stakeholders involved. Engagement methods will therefore include:

A. Stakeholder Participation in Project prioritization

- The residents through their Ward Development Committees and other community leaders have identified projects that need to be implemented in all the sectors. The projects have been captured in the District Integrated Development Plan (IDP). The Local Authority will therefore, engage the citizens through the Traditional and religious leaders, Community – Based Organizations, and Ward Development Committees to prioritize projects which can be implemented this year.

B. Public consultation and keeping citizens informed through the budget cycle

- Budget hearing at District level will be conducted ahead of time to keep stakeholders informed of the performance of the 2025 budget and to obtain feedback regarding allocations to different programs/sub-programs. Key outputs, and selected projects.

C. Citizen Monitoring of Budget and Project Implementation

- The Local Authority will engage citizens in the monitoring of public projects under implementation. Sub-district structures such as the Ward Development Committees, Community Welfare Assistance Committees, etc. will be capacity built in basic project monitoring to ensure that they monitor selected projects on behalf of the intended beneficiaries.
- Improve reporting to citizens on the outputs of the budget implementation. This will be achieved through:

- ✓ Uploading quarterly budget performance reports on various social media platforms created to easy interaction between the Local Authority and the residents through the Ward Development Committees
- ✓ Publish regular updates and reports on the status of project implementation and budget performance
- ✓ Hold biannual community engagement meetings to provide feedback to the residents on project status and budget performance
- ✓ Incorporate key stakeholders in project monitoring

3. Implementation Plan

3.1.1 Assessment of the stakeholder engagement in the budget process

C – Current level of Engagement

D – Desired level of Engagement

STAKEHOLDERS	POWER/ INTEREST	UNAWARE	RESISTANT	NEUTRAL	SUPPORTIVE	LEADING
1. Traders	Low/ High		C		D	
2. Industries	Low/High		C		D	
3. Transporters	Low/High			C	D	
4. Small-scale farmers	Low/High			C	D	
5. Commercial farmers	Low/High			C	D	
6. Ward Development Committees	Low/High				C	D
7. Traditional Leaders	Low/High				C	D
8. Civic Leaders	High/High				C	C

3.1.2 Assessment of stakeholder engagement in project prioritization

C – Current level of Engagement

D – Desired level of Engagement

STAKEHOLDERS	POWER/ INTEREST	UNAWARE	RESISTANT	NEUTRAL	SUPPORTIVE	LEADING
1. Traditional Leaders	High/ High				C	D
2. Civic Leaders	High/High				C	D
3. CDF Committees	High/High				D C	
4. Ward Development Committees	Low/High				C	D
5. Community groups	Low/High				C	D
6. Community based organizations	Low/High				C	D
7. Faith -based Organizations	Low/High			C		D
8. Traditional Leaders	Low/High				C	D

3.1.3 Assessment of stakeholder engagement in project budget and project monitoring

C – Current level of Engagement

D – Desired level of Engagement

STAKEHOLDERS	POWER/ INTEREST	UNAWARE	RESISTANT	NEUTRAL	SUPPORTIVE	LEADING
9. Traditional Leaders	Low/ High			C		D
10. Civic Leaders	High/High				C	D
11. CDF Committees	High/High				C	D
12. Ward Development Committees	Low/High				C	D
13. Community groups	Low/High			C		D
14. Community based organizations	Low/High			C		D
15. Faith -based Organizations	Low/High			C		D

3.2 Citizen Engagement Strategy

BUDGET STAGE/PURPOSE OF THE MEETING	KEY FEATURES/ACTIVITIES	STAKEHOLDER CATEGORY INVOLVED	TIMELINE
Enhancement of Revenue Mobilization for the 2025 Budget	1. Sensitize WDC Committee on their role in revenue mobilization and recruitment of revenue agents	Ward Development Committees	10 th – 17 th March, 2024
Engagement meeting with 2022-2024 CDF Loan Beneficiaries	1. Hold engagement meeting with loan beneficiaries with a view of improving loan recoveries	CDF Empowerment Loan Beneficiaries	23 rd May, 2024
Public Sensitization on CDF	1. Conduct community engagement meetings to enhance accessibility of the Constituency Development Fund	WDC General Public	August -September, 2024
Preparation for 2025 budget formulation	1. Provide stakeholders with Citizen Engagement Strategy outlining proposed date for consultation	All stakeholders (Traditional and Religious Leaders, WDCs, Business Community, CBOs)	18 th – 22 nd September, 2024
	2. Provide stakeholders through WDCs with a comprehensive list of proposed projects for consideration in the 206 Financial year for prioritization	All Ward Development Committee Meetings	25 th September, 2024
	3. Receive a list of projects shortlisted by WDCs for appraisal and possible funding	All stakeholders through WDCs	29 th September, 2024
	4. Conduct budget hearings in all the three	All stakeholders	13 th – 17 th October, 2024

	Chiefdoms (2026 -2028 Budget Estimates)		
Budget Approval (Public Awareness of Budget Details)	1. Review the 2026 proposed budget and assess the inclusion of the inputs from the stakeholders	All stakeholders	20 th – 23 rd October, 2024
	2. Provide feedback to WDCs and other stakeholders on the final budget to be presented for Provincial and National Hearing	All stakeholders through WDCs	31 st October, 2024
Budget execution and monitoring (for transparency in budget implementation)	1. Involvement of key stakeholders in budget and project implementation	WDC Chairpersons	Throughout the budget and project implementation
	2. Providing feedback to WDCs on the status of the projects under implementation	All stakeholders through WDCs	Quarterly
Budget Evaluation and	1. Evaluate the impact of allocated funds, focusing on agreed upon programs with a bias towards gender, persons with disabilities, child	All stakeholders	After completion of the project

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4 Communication Plan

DELIVERABLE/ ACTIVITY	TARGET STAKEHOLDERS	FREQUENCY	PROPOSED TIMELINE/ DATE	RESPONSIBILITY	COMMUNICATION METHOD	COMMENTS
1. Sensitize WDC Committee on their role in revenue mobilization and recruitment of revenue agents	Ward Development Committees	2	10 th – 17 th March, 2024	- Director of Finance - Director Planning - Socio-economic Planner - Public Relations Officer	Community Engagement Meeting	
2. Focus Group Discussion on identifying projects which would make an impact on the community	Ward Development Committees, Satellite Disaster Management Committees, CWACs, Civic Leaders, Traditional and Religious Leaders	19	14 th – 25 th April, 2024	- Socio-economic Planner - Assistant Director of Engineering Services - Public Relations Officer	Community Engagement Meeting	
3. Hold engagement meeting with loan beneficiaries with a view of improving loan recoveries	2022 – 2024 CDF Empowerment Loan Beneficiaries	1	23rd May, 2024	- Director of Planning - Director of Finance - Public Relation Officer	Loan beneficiaries meeting	
4. Conduct community engagement meetings to enhance accessibility of the Constituency Development Fund	WDC General Public	19	18 th – 30 th August, 2024	- Socio-economic Planners - Public Relations Officers	Community	
5. Provide stakeholders with Citizen Engagement Strategy outlining proposed date for consultation	All stakeholders (Traditional and Religious Leaders, WDCs, Business Community, CBOs,	One-off	18 th – 22 nd September, 2024	- Socio-economic Planner - Public Relations Officer	- Uploading the plan on the website and social media platforms - Distribution of the approved Citizen Engagement Strategy	
6. Provide stakeholders through WDCs with a comprehensive list of proposed projects for consideration in the 206 Financial year for prioritization	Traditional leaders Ward Development Committees	One - off	25 th September, 2024	- Chief planner - Assistant Director of Engineering Services - Socio-economic Planner - Public Relations Officer	Community engagement meetings	
7. Receive a list of projects shortlisted by WDCs for appraisal and possible funding	Ward Development Committees	Once-off	29 th September, 2024	- Chief planner - Assistant Director of Engineering Services - Socio-economic Planner - Public Relations Officer - Director of Finance	Physical meeting with the Ward Development Committees	
8. Conduct budget hearings in all the three Chiefdoms	WDCs, Business Community, Civic Leaders, Traditional	3	13 th – 17 th October, 2024	- Director of Finance - Director of Planning	Physical meetings with the listed stakeholders	

(2025 -2027 Budget Estimates)	and Religious Leaders, Community Based Organizations			Director of Engineering Services Public Relations Officer	
9. Review the 2025 proposed budget and assess the inclusion of the inputs from the stakeholders	WDCs	1	20 th – 23 rd October, 2024	- Director of Finance - Director of Planning - Director of Engineering Services - Public Relations Officer	Focus Group Discussion
10. Provide feedback to WDCs and other stakeholders on the final budget to be presented for Provincial and National Hearing	All stakeholders through WDCs	1	31 st October, 2024	- Director of Finance - Director of Planning	Social media reports
11. Providing feedback to WDCs on the status of the projects under implementation	All stakeholders through WDCs	Quarterly		- Assistant Director of Engineering Services - Chief Planner - Public Relations Officer	- Social Media Reports - Physical Community Engagement Meetings

5. Budget for the Implementation of the Citizen Engagement Strategy

S/N	Item Description	Unit Measure	Unit Cost	No. of Units	Total
1	Fuel	Litre	25.00	800	20,000.00
2	Bond paper	Box	800	10	8,000.00
3	Pen/markers	Box	120	5	600.00
4	Toner	Each	3000	4	12,000.00
5	Hire of Public Address System	Day	600	5	3,000.00
6	Running adverts on Radio	Day	1500	4	6,000.00
7	Chief's Homage	Chief	1000	4	4,000.00
8	Mineral Water	Case	120	50	6,000.00
9	Soft Drinks	Case	180	45	8,100.00
10	Biscuits	Case	600	20	12,000.00
11	Transport refunds	Individual	300	110	33,000.00
12	Missing lunch for officers for 20 days	Day	3000	6	15,000.00
	Total				112,700.00

6. Monitoring, Evaluation and Reporting

The Local Authority will consistently monitor the progress made towards the implementation of the Citizen Engagement Strategy and will use the findings to inform decision-making and adjust the implementation plan. In addition, the feedback and grievance redress mechanism will be used to receive and respond to grievances from all the stakeholders. The Local Authority will also share the monitoring reports with all the stakeholders through various social media platforms, and the same reports will be uploaded on the website.

6.1 Monitoring and evaluation framework

Output	KEY PERFORMANCE INDICATOR	TARGET	MEANS OF VERIFICATION	COMMENT
WDCs sensitized on their role in revenue mobilization and recruitment of revenue agents	Number of meetings held	2	Meeting reports	
	Number of participants	40	Attendance registers	
	Number of revenue agents recruited	-		
	Number of meeting held	12	Reports	
Focus Group Discussion on identifying projects which would make an impact on the community	Number of stakeholders who attended the meeting	30	attendance registers	
Hold engagement meeting with loan beneficiaries with a view of improving loan recoveries	Number of meetings held	2	Meeting reports, and attendance register	
	Number of Loan Beneficiaries who attended the meeting	44	Meeting reports, and attendance register	
	Percentage of funds recovered	30	Loan recovery statements	
	Numbers of CDF sensitization meetings held	20	Reports, and attendance registers	
CDF Sensitization meetings held District Budget Hearing conducted	Number of budget hearing meetings conducted	2	Meeting reports, attendance registers	
	Number of stakeholders involved	60		
	Number of projects identified, by the community	1	Meeting reports (resolution), attendance re	
	Number of applications received	20	Application forms received, and list of projects applied for	
Community projects to be implemented identified - ZDSP	Number of projects approved for implementation	7	PLGO's Conveyance letter, and list of approved projects	
Community projects to be implemented identified - CDF				

7. Conclusion

The development of this Citizen Engagement Strategy emphasizes the Local Authority's appreciation for inclusive development. This plan will help to address the challenges the Local Authority has been experiencing over the years in bringing different stakeholders on board regarding budgeting, project identification, implementation, and evaluation. The successful implementation of this plan will help to enhance transparency and accountability in the utilization of public resources, and we ensure the actualization of meaning decentralization as the opinions of more residents in the district will be incorporated in the budget formulation process, project identification, prioritization and execution. This plan also emphasizes the need to give regular feedback on budget performance, and progress of projects under implementation to the residents in order to keep them informed on the status of development in the District.

Finally, it is imperative to indicate that, the success of this plan depends on the stakeholder's willingness to join hands with the Local Authority by ensuring that they attend meetings whenever called upon, and provide either positive or negative feedback to the Local Authority with a view of improving budget performance and project implementation.

7. Conclusion

The development of this Citizen Engagement Strategy emphasizes the Local Authority's appreciation for inclusive development. This plan will help to address the challenges the Local Authority has been experiencing over the years in bringing different stakeholders on board regarding budgeting, project identification, implementation, and evaluation. The successful implementation of this plan will help to enhance transparency and accountability in the utilization of public resources, and we ensure the actualization of meaning decentralization as the opinions of more residents in the district will be incorporated in the budget formulation process, project identification, prioritization and execution. This plan also emphasizes the need to give regular feedback on budget performance, and progress of projects under implementation to the residents in order to keep them informed on the status of development in the District.

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LUFWANYAMA TOWN COUNCIL

**EXTRACT MINUTES OF THE FOURTH (4TH) ORDINARY COUNCIL MEETING HELD IN
CHAMBER, CIVIC CENTRE, LUFWANYAMA ALONG KALENGWA ROAD ON THURSDAY, 19TH
DECEMBER 2024 AT 09:30 HOURS**

COUNCILLORS

PRESENT

Annie Kapandula	-	Council Chairperson	
Gilbert Mukobola	-	Vice Council chairperson	Chinemu
Lenox Kaseka	-	Member	Sokontwe
Patson Sikwimba	-	Member	Kabundia
Grehiam Sawalonga	-	Member	Luswishi
Zolile Zimba	-	Member	Mibenge
Chooye Himaluwani	-	Member	Lwabufubu
Lee Mukanzo	-	Member	Kasonka
Moses Kazeka	-	Member	Chantete
Edward Kapandula	-	Member	Katembula
Soul Kapepa	-	Member	Lufwanyama
Martin Mulambo	-	Member	Mitwe
Derick Choosa	-	Member	Bulaya
Ernest Mushikita	-	Member	Mukumbo
Dickson Chabala	-	Member	
Nickson Lungebe	-	Member	Mwelushi
Mwashi Matela	-	Member	Mushingashi
Chola Kanda	-	Member	Mpindi
Stephen Mukinina	-	Member	Kansanta
Chewe Kabanda	-	Member	Chibanga
Chief Mukutuma	-	Member	Chiefdom

ABSENT WITH

APOLOGY

Chief Nkana	-	Member	Chiefdom
Chieftainess Shimukunami	-	Member	Chiefdom

IN ATTENDANCE

Lynda F. Mapara	-	Council Secretary
Chali K. Mwansa	-	Director of HR and Administration
Bwalya Machuta	-	Director Finance
Agness Phiri	-	Council Advocate
Mwendalubi Phiri	-	Assistant Director of Engineering

Christopher Kanyanta
 Innocent Pwele
 Paul Chiteme
 Asan Muchele
 Mwangula Litungu
 Maron Kombe
 Terry Siyumbano
 Susan Jere
 Kafwana Kyembe
 Siphwe Ndhlovu
 Agness Miti
 Chewa Chanda
 Mapenzi Siadunka
 Reuben Banda
 Oswell Katota
 Muka Nyambe
 Prince Nyendwa
 Mutipanai Muyangwa
 Minimo Milimo
 Bright Chiboko
 Eugene Mweemba
 Albertina Chilumanda
 Geofferey Mulowa
 Luyando Choongo
 Teddy Mayani

- Chief Accountant
- Chief Human Resource Officer
- Internal Auditor
- Internal Audit Assistant
- Civil Engineer
- Chief Planner
- Director Community Services
- District Forestry Officer
- Environmental Planner
- District Aids Coordinator Advisor
- Community Development Officer
- Assistant Procurement Officer
- Senior Health Inspector
- Architect
- Executive Officer (OP)
- Senior Legal Assistant
- Assistant Commercial Manager
- Director of Water Development
- Social Welfare Officer
- ZULAWU – Chairperson
- District Fisheries & Livestock coordinator
- District Education Board
- Clerical Officer
- Registry Clerk
- Committee Clerk

NATIONAL ANTHEM

Prior to the commencement of the meeting, the National Anthem was sung and thereafter Councillor Lenox Kaseka led the meeting in an opening prayer.

LTC/24/12/2025

NOTICE OF MEETING

The Council Secretary read the notice of meeting in accordance with the Section 23 (1) of the Local Government Act No. 2 of 2019, Chapter 281 of the Laws of Zambia read together with the Standing Order.

LTC/98/12/2024

APPROVAL OF THE CITIZEN ENGAGEMENT STRATEGY FOR 2025

It was reported for the consideration of the council that the department of planning had formulated the citizen engagement strategy plan to enable the council effectively and in a transparent manner engage communities in various issues affecting them. It was stated that the document attached as APPENDIX 5 had been submitted for the consideration of the council.

The council secretary further explained that the plan would help the communities in project identification and prioritization, project implementation and monitoring and budget formulation process. Thus the development of the said document was cardinal in promoting transparency and accountability in utilization of public resources.

Therefore, on a proposal by councillor Lee Mukanzo and duly seconded by councillor Edward Kapandula, it was;

RESOLVED

That the citizen engagement strategic plan for 2025 be APPROVED.

Certified true and correct copy of the minutes of the fourth (4th) Ordinary Council meeting held on Thursday, 19th December 2024.

Signed this.....27.....Day.....December.....2024



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Council Secretary

